

# Student Journalism - Technical Report Proposal

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## 1 Overview

This proposal details my idea of a side project involving the student articles dataset.

The broad goal is to expand the CCN's current work on student journalism and its current works by exploring **how do student outlets with different institutional backgrounds differ in the topics they report?**.

## 2 Project pipeline

*This sections details my interpretation of how we can go through this project from data to findings to visualization. Broadly, it'll begin with cleaning the data, extracting aggregate findings, writing a technical report, and exploring potential data viz outlets.*

**Data.** The primary unit of analysis would be the articles scraped within your dataset. We will also utilize a taxonomic framework to classify the topics so either Friedland et al. 2012's topic breakdown of critical information needs or the broader IPTC framework.

**Analysis.** The broad goal is to classify all the articles within your dataset similar to the Local Journalism Index. CCN had a previous report titled "Bridging Campus and Community: How Student Media are Filling Local News Gaps", and one of their suggested future directions is:

Additional research could attempt to quantify the numbers and types of community news stories produced by student media or examine the number and kind of stories published or co-published in local news outlets or made publicly available.

Therefore, to contribute to CCN's current understanding, I propose we apply a similar framework of the work we're currently doing. We would first have to attribute each article to an institutional type such as university, college, community college, etc.

This framework, broadly, goes as follows:

1. classify each article with a fixed taxonomy
2. we would aggregate on the institution-level where we could then compare outlet and institution types

**Technical report.** We would then compose a technical report similar to that of CCN to report on descriptive findings, general implications, etc.

**Data Visualization.** As a fun additional deliverable, I would want to develop either a static, interactive, or even unorthodox form of data visualization to specifically visualize the distribution of topic type among different institutional types.

### 3 Data Visualization Ideas

**Radar chart:** The first idea that comes to mind is a radar chart. Assuming we developed 4 to 6 dimensional taxonomy framework, we could map each institutional type to their respective topic type.

**Supecluster Map:** This repo contains documentation for superclustering and mapping data within clusters geospatially. Perhaps we could map article type geospatially?

*!!Ambitious idea!!*

**Universe of student journalism content:** To really visualize how student journalism content vary across different institutional types and connect that with the principles of ecosystems, we could form a "constellation" or "universe" in n-dimensional space where stories form a region of the universe.

- Each dot would be an article
- Articles that are similar, by topic, etc, are placed near each other.
- We would begin to form clusters of topics.
- Within each cluster, we would form a larger distinction with each article having their own keywords that connected that article to the larger cluster.
- We could have each dot being able to display that specific article and its metadata.
- to visualize different institutional types, we would just color each dot a respective color.
- maybe we could form planes, connecting each dot to form surfaces of institutional types?